

You **do not need to buy a domain or pay for traditional web hosting to put a basic website online**. Services such as **GitHub Pages** and **Cloudflare Pages** can give you a free web address and host simple websites. For example, GitHub can give you an address like `yourname.github.io`, while Cloudflare Pages provides a `yourproject.pages.dev` address.

Using GitHub Pages

Create a free account on [GitHub](#) and make a **public repository** for the website. Add an `index.html` file, which becomes the site's main page, along with any other files you want available. Then go to **Repository** → **Settings** → **Pages**, choose the repository branch as the publishing source, and GitHub will publish the site and give you its web address. On GitHub's free plan, Pages can be published from public repositories.

These sites can contain much more than plain text. You can publish **PDFs, images, downloadable files, resource lists, guides, articles, portfolios, directories, buttons and links to other websites**, as well as complete pages designed with HTML and CSS. JavaScript can also be used for interactive features. GitHub Pages is specifically designed for static HTML, CSS, JavaScript and other static files.

This makes free static hosting especially useful when you simply need to **get information or resources onto the internet**. You could create a page containing nothing more than a title and links to several PDFs, or build it into a polished multi-page resource website later. No custom domain is necessary, although one can be connected later. One limitation is that GitHub Pages is not intended to serve as free hosting for an online store/SaaS or sensitive transactions such as collecting passwords or credit-card information.

Another option is [Cloudflare Pages](#), which works on the same general principle: publish static website files and receive a free `pages.dev` address. Cloudflare also supports static HTML, images, PDFs and other static assets, making it another option for simple public resource sites.